



PRACTICAL AI SYSTEMS

□ FREE FIELD GUIDE • 2026 EDITION

15 AI Automations That Save Your Team Time and Drive Revenue

Real-world AI automations for modern teams

Each play includes a concrete workflow, a vetted starter stack, the number to measure, and the moment a person should stay in control.

WHY THESE WORKFLOWS

Automate the handoffs around the work.

The best first automation is rarely a fully autonomous agent. It is a frequent, measurable handoff with clear inputs, a known owner, and an easy fallback.

60%

of the average seller's time is spent away from selling

SALESFORCE RESEARCH, 2026 [↗](#)

14%

more support issues resolved per hour with AI assistance

NBER STUDY OF 5,000+ AGENTS [↗](#)

50 min

saved per user each week reading email in one field study

MICROSOFT WORKLAB [↗](#)



Start with one outcome.

Choose a workflow with enough volume to matter. Capture a two-week baseline, automate the smallest end-to-end slice, and compare time, quality, and business results—not the number of AI tasks run.

Capture demand

05 PLAYS

REVENUE

Give sellers more time for conversations and make sure strong intent never waits in a queue.

01	REVENUE AUTOMATION Qualify and route inbound leads in minutes Turn a bare form fill into a scored, enriched lead and put it in front of the right rep while interest is still high. HOW IT WORKS 1 A form, webinar, or demo request creates the lead 2 AI enriches the person and company, checks ICP fit, and explains the score 3 Routing rules assign qualified leads by territory or round robin and place the remaining leads into nurture PRACTICAL STARTER STACK Clay enrichment + scoring HubSpot CRM + ownership n8n open-source orchestration	MEASURE Median speed-to-lead, qualified-lead rate, and lead-to-opportunity conversion. GUARDRAIL Use deterministic rules for territory, consent, suppression, and strategic accounts. Copy Clay's inbound lead workflow
02	REVENUE AUTOMATION Turn buying signals into researched outreach Watch for meaningful events such as funding, hiring, product launches, leadership changes, and high-intent site visits, then give reps a timely reason to reach out. HOW IT WORKS 1 A first- or third-party intent signal enters the workflow 2 AI researches the account, validates the signal, and maps it to your offer 3 A rep receives a cited account brief and a personalized draft to approve PRACTICAL STARTER STACK Clay signals + web research HubSpot Agent Hub CRM-native prospecting Apollo contacts + sequencing	MEASURE Positive reply rate, meetings per 100 accounts, and pipeline created per signal. GUARDRAIL Require a verifiable source for every trigger and human approval until message quality is stable. See a signal-based workflow pattern

03

REVENUE AUTOMATION

Convert every sales call into follow-up and clean CRM data

Stop asking sellers to retype meetings. Capture the call, summarize the buying context, draft the follow-up, and log the right fields automatically.

HOW IT WORKS

1

A recorded meeting is transcribed after the call

2

AI extracts pains, stakeholders, objections, commitments, dates, and next steps

3

The summary and tasks sync to the matching opportunity; the rep approves the email draft

PRACTICAL STARTER STACK

Fathom notes + action items

Gong conversation intelligence

Salesforce CRM system of record

MEASURE

CRM field completion, follow-up time, overdue next steps, and stage conversion.

GUARDRAIL

Require rep approval for customer-facing messages and deal-stage changes, and record commitments exactly as stated.

Review Fathom's CRM sync behavior

04

REVENUE AUTOMATION

Draft RFPs and security questionnaires from approved answers

Give proposal teams a cited first draft, then route uncertain or stale answers to subject-matter experts.

HOW IT WORKS

1

A Word, PDF, spreadsheet, or portal questionnaire is imported and split into requirements

2

AI matches each question to governed answers, policies, case studies, and prior responses

3

Low-confidence items go to the correct expert; approved answers flow back into the final format

PRACTICAL STARTER STACK

Loopio response management

Responsive RFP + infosec responses

SharePoint approved source library

MEASURE

Time to first draft, SME touches per response, on-time submission rate, and win rate.

GUARDRAIL

Restrict generation to approved sources and require owners to verify legal, security, pricing, and roadmap claims.

Explore cited automated answers

05

REVENUE AUTOMATION

Re-engage stalled and previously lost opportunities

Continuously look for deals with a credible new reason to restart the conversation and use that reason to shape the outreach.

HOW IT WORKS

1

A closed-lost or inactive opportunity becomes eligible after a defined quiet period

2

AI compares the loss reason with new product, pricing, company, and account signals

3

High-confidence matches create a personalized draft and task for the original owner

PRACTICAL STARTER STACK

HubSpot deal context + agent

Customer.io behavioral journeys

Make workflow orchestration

MEASURE

Reactivated opportunities, reply rate, recovered pipeline, and recovered revenue.

GUARDRAIL

Honor opt-outs and contact limits; suppress accounts with unresolved complaints or explicit no-contact requests.

See a real-world lead recovery case

Serve and retain customers

04 PLAYS

CUSTOMER Use AI to improve speed and coverage while preserving a thoughtful path to a person.

06

CUSTOMER AUTOMATION

Resolve repeat support questions with verified answers

Answer high-volume, low-risk questions immediately using your help center and product data, with a clear escalation path to a human.

HOW IT WORKS

1

A customer asks a question in chat or email

2

AI retrieves the relevant approved content, asks clarifying questions, and answers with context

3

Unanswered, sensitive, or frustrated conversations transfer with a full summary

PRACTICAL STARTER STACK

Intercom Fin AI support agent

Zendesk AI service automation

n8n RAG custom/open workflow

MEASURE

Automation rate, resolution rate, CSAT, reopen rate, and cost per resolution.

GUARDRAIL

Auto-escalate billing disputes, cancellations, safety issues, angry sentiment, and low-confidence answers.

Read the field study on AI-assisted support

07

CUSTOMER AUTOMATION

Triage every request before it reaches the queue

Classify intent, urgency, customer tier, language, and required data as soon as a message arrives so specialists receive a ready-to-work case.

HOW IT WORKS

1

An email, form, chat, or portal request arrives

2

AI extracts identifiers, summarizes the issue, labels the topic, and detects urgency

3

Rules route the case, update the CRM or order system, and start the correct SLA

PRACTICAL STARTER STACK

Front

shared inbox + AI

Zendesk

ticketing + routing

OpenAI API

custom classification

MEASURE

First-assignment accuracy, time to first response, transfers per ticket, and SLA breaches.

GUARDRAIL

Use fixed routing rules for VIP, regulatory, security, and safety queues; log classification confidence.

See Front's topic-based routing

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CUSTOMER AUTOMATION

Detect churn risk and expansion intent early

Monitor what customers say and do across calls, tickets, product usage, and email to surface risk or buying momentum before the renewal meeting.

HOW IT WORKS

1

Customer communications and product signals update continuously

2

AI detects sentiment shifts, stakeholder disengagement, unresolved issues, and expansion language

3

The CSM receives evidence, severity, next-best action, and a dated task

PRACTICAL STARTER STACK

Gainsight

customer success platform

Staircase AI

conversation signals

Vitaly

customer health + playbooks

MEASURE

Risk lead time, gross retention, save rate, expansion pipeline, and forecast accuracy.

GUARDRAIL

Show the source evidence behind every risk and require additional signals before changing health scores or forecasts.

Study Gainsight's Risk Analyst workflow

http://127.0.0.1:4173/resources/15-ai-automations/

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CUSTOMER AUTOMATION

Publish a weekly voice-of-customer brief automatically

Turn thousands of conversations into a short, cited brief of recurring pain points, feature requests, objections, praise, and emerging themes.

HOW IT WORKS

1

New calls, tickets, reviews, and survey comments are collected in one analysis set

2

AI clusters themes, counts examples, compares changes, and selects representative evidence

3

A weekly brief is delivered to product, marketing, sales, and support owners

PRACTICAL STARTER STACK

Dovetail

research synthesis

Front Topics

conversation taxonomy

Zapier

collection + delivery

MEASURE

Feedback coverage, time-to-insight, themes acted on, and repeated issue volume.

GUARDRAIL

Include counts and source excerpts, strip personal data, and label AI interpretations clearly.

Learn AI-powered thematic analysis

Turn expertise into attention

02 PLAYS

MARKETING Create more useful touchpoints from work your team has already done.

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MARKETING AUTOMATION

Turn one recording into a week of content

Transform a webinar, podcast, demo, or interview into short clips, a recap, social drafts, an email, and a sales enablement snippet.

HOW IT WORKS

1

A new long-form recording lands in the content folder

2

AI transcribes it, finds strong moments, reframes clips, and drafts channel-specific copy

3

An editor approves the claims, voice, and final publishing schedule

PRACTICAL STARTER STACK

Descript

transcript-based editing

OpusClip

automated short clips

Buffer

approval + scheduling

MEASURE

Production hours per asset, assets per recording, qualified traffic, and assisted pipeline.

GUARDRAIL

Require editorial review; verify quotes and remove confidential or customer-identifying moments.

See the AI clipping workflow

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MARKETING AUTOMATION

Personalize lifecycle messages from real behavior

Replace one-size-fits-all drips with messages shaped by what each person has done, skipped, asked, or struggled with.

HOW IT WORKS

1

A product or CRM event, such as trial inactivity, feature adoption, cart abandonment, or renewal proximity, starts a journey

2

AI selects the relevant proof point, education, or next step and adapts the draft to the segment

3

Rules cap frequency, test variants, and escalate high-value intent to a person

PRACTICAL STARTER STACK

Customer.io event-driven journeys

Braze cross-channel engagement

HubSpot CRM-native automation

MEASURE

Activation, reply, conversion, unsubscribe, and revenue per journey.

GUARDRAIL

Use consented data, cap send frequency, lock claims and offers, and maintain a non-AI fallback message.

Follow a practical LLM personalization experiment

Remove back-office drag

02 PLAYS

OPERATIONS Convert document-heavy workflows into controlled, measurable systems.

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OPERATIONS AUTOMATION

Capture, code, and route invoices automatically

Move invoices from a shared inbox into the accounting system with extracted line items, suggested coding, duplicate checks, and the correct approval path.

HOW IT WORKS

1

An invoice arrives by email or upload

2

OCR and AI extract fields, match the vendor and PO, suggest codes, and flag anomalies

3

Bills follow the appropriate approval path, with mismatches highlighted for AP review

PRACTICAL STARTER STACK

Ramp Bill Pay AP automation + agents

Rossum document processing

Nanonets OCR + workflow automation

MEASURE

Cost per invoice, touchless rate, approval cycle time, duplicate payments, and exceptions.

GUARDRAIL

Separate invoice capture, approval, and payment permissions; require review for new vendors or changed bank details.

Review Ramp's AP agent controls

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OPERATIONS AUTOMATION

Run a first-pass contract intake and review

Extract commercial terms, compare clauses with your playbook, suggest narrow redlines, and route the actual exceptions to legal.

HOW IT WORKS

1

A vendor or customer agreement enters the intake workflow

2

AI extracts dates, value, renewal, data terms, and non-standard clauses with citations

3

Standard language advances; deviations receive suggested edits and the right approver

PRACTICAL STARTER STACK

Ironclad

CLM + AI playbooks

Juro

contract automation

DocuSign

agreement management

MEASURE

Time to first review, legal touches, cycle time, deviations found, and missed renewals.

GUARDRAIL

Require an authorized legal or business owner to review AI-prepared materials, accept terms, and send redlines.

See cited contract intake in practice

Scale knowledge and reliability

02 PLAYS

TEAM

Make hard-won company context available at the moment someone needs it.

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TEAM AUTOMATION

Answer internal questions from company knowledge

Give people one place to ask "How do we...?" across docs, wikis, tickets, chat, and code, with permission-aware answers that cite the source.

HOW IT WORKS

1

Approved company sources are indexed under their existing access controls

2

A teammate asks a question in plain language and gets a concise, cited answer

3

Unanswered questions become a knowledge gap assigned to the source owner

PRACTICAL STARTER STACK

Glean

enterprise search + agents

Microsoft 365 Copilot

Microsoft work graph

Guru

verified knowledge

MEASURE

Search time, repeat questions, answer success, onboarding time, and stale-source rate.

GUARDRAIL

Enforce source permissions at retrieval time, show citations, and assign owners and expiry dates to policies.

Read Glean's implementation quick start

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TEAM AUTOMATION

Triage production incidents and draft the fix

Combine errors, traces, logs, releases, and code context so engineers start with a probable root cause and a reviewable patch.

HOW IT WORKS

1

Monitoring groups a new error and attaches runtime context

2

AI scores actionability, investigates the root cause, and proposes a solution

3

For well-bounded issues, it drafts code changes or opens a pull request for review

PRACTICAL STARTER STACK

Sentry Seer

AI debugging agent

GitHub Copilot

code assistance

PagerDuty

incident orchestration

MEASURE

Mean time to acknowledge, mean time to resolve, alert noise, regressions, and engineer hours per incident.

GUARDRAIL

Run tests, require code-owner approval, and keep production deployment under human control.

See Sentry Seer's end-to-end flow

→

A SENSIBLE ROLLOUT

Prove value before adding autonomy.

Move from assistant to autopilot only when the evidence says the system is accurate, useful, and recoverable.

